



A Study Companion

Your Word Is Your Wand

A Sequel to The Game of Life and How to Play It

Florence Scovel Shinn

New Thought · 1941

Important Insights & Action Guide

The Question

How do you change a circumstance — lack, sickness, fear, conflict, failure — when it looks fixed and set against you?

Shinn's Answer

Shinn's answer is that your spoken word is a creative instrument — a “wand.” Declared with fearless faith and a vivid mental picture, the word impresses the subconscious mind, and outer conditions rearrange to match it. You do not wrestle the appearance directly; you speak the truth over it — health where there is sickness, plenty where there is lack — and act as though it is already done. As she quotes it: “by thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.”

The Framework

The book moves through three natural stages — the law behind the word, the practice of working it, and its application to every kind of condition.

I The Word and the Law

Why speech is creative, and what makes it work: the imaging faculty and the fearless, unmoved state a word must be spoken from.

II Working the Word

The practice — acting your faith, refusing to fight obstacles, guarding what you say, giving first, and following the lead of intuition.

III The Word Over Every Condition

Applying the method across money, loss, love, the body and the elements, and gathering it into a single repeatable move.

The Insights

The ideas most worth carrying out of the book, grouped by stage. Each closes with a single line to remember.



THE WORD AND THE LAW

Why speech is creative, and what makes it work: the imaging faculty and the fearless, unmoved state a word must be spoken from.

Your word is a wand

Shinn's founding claim is that speech is not description but cause. What you declare with conviction tends to objectify itself in your circumstances. The same tongue that names a problem can name the outcome instead.

Why it matters — It relocates power. If words shape conditions, then the lever you have been looking for outside is your own daily speech — available in any situation.

In the book — A woman came for help with money holding just two dollars. Shinn had her bless the two dollars and declare she carried “the magic purse of the spirit... crammed, jammed with money.” Shortly afterward she was given six thousand dollars.

In practice — Catch what you habitually say about your situation, and speak the result you want rather than the trouble you see.

Speak the outcome, not the problem.

Choose words that flash a picture

The subconscious, Shinn says, responds to images, not abstractions. The “imaging faculty” is the creative faculty, so the craft is to pick words that make you actually see the thing — “crammed, jammed” does what “more money” cannot. And you never force or strain a picture; you let the idea flash into mind on its own.

Why it matters — A vague request doesn't move you and doesn't move the subconscious. A vivid one produces a flash of the fulfilled result — which is what carries the charge.

In the book — The purse affirmation works, she notes, precisely because it is impossible to say “crammed, jammed” without seeing the wallet full.

In practice — Before you speak an intention, rephrase it in concrete, sensory language you can picture. If you can't see it, reword it.

If you can't picture it, you haven't phrased it yet.

Fearless faith — the unmoved center

A word only works, in this system, when it is spoken without fear, doubt, resentment or anger. Standing calm, contented and even-tempered while appearances are against you is what Shinn calls mastery. “Power moves, but is never moved.” Emotional control is the precondition for everything else.

Why it matters — Fear cancels the word; poise carries it. She states the mechanism plainly: fear and impatience demagnetize, poise magnetizes.

In the book — A woman at sea woke to foghorns and a dense fog. She declared, “there are no fogs in divine mind... I give thanks for the sun,” and — in her account — the sun soon came out.

In practice — Settle your state before you speak. Let the fear or urgency drop, then say the word from steadiness.

Fear demagnetizes; poise magnetizes.

II

WORKING THE WORD

The practice — acting your faith, refusing to fight obstacles, guarding what you say, giving first, and following the lead of intuition.

Active faith: dig your ditches

Faith here is not passive hoping; it is acting as though the answer is already on its way. Shinn's image is digging ditches before the rain — preparing for the thing asked for. “Faith without works is dead.”

Why it matters — The visible act of preparation is what impresses the subconscious with certainty. It is the difference between a “hope chest” and a “faith chest.”

In the book — A woman couldn't rent her room for weeks. Shinn asked whether she'd acted on any hunch; the woman admitted she'd wanted to buy a lamp but decided she couldn't afford it. Told the four-dollar lamp was standing between her and the right tenant, she bought two — and the perfect renter appeared within a week.

In practice — Take one concrete step that only makes sense if the answer is already coming.

Prepare for it before you can see it.

Non-resistance: walk up to the lion

What you resist, Shinn argues, persists and enlarges, because hating a thing paints a vivid picture of it that then objectifies. The move is to bless the obstacle instead of fighting it, so it becomes a stepping-stone. “I walk up to the lion on my pathway and find an angel in armor.”

Why it matters — Fighting an appearance feeds it. Non-resistance drains its charge and often dissolves it.

In the book — A woman kept meeting men who spoke of beloved women cousins, which made her jealous — and the cousins kept reappearing. When she finally blessed “all the cousins in the universe” and sent goodwill, she never heard of cousins again.

In practice — The moment resentment or jealousy rises, send the thing goodwill and name it a stepping-stone.

Make friends with the hindrance.

Guard your speech — what you dwell on returns

The tongue condemns as surely as it justifies. Repeating your troubles multiplies them; the thing you fear or hate “will surely come upon you,” because your words are instructions you keep re-issuing to the subconscious.

Why it matters — You are always talking to yourself about your life. Whatever you rehearse out loud, you reinforce.

In the book — A woman went about telling people “I know what trouble is” and waiting for their sympathy — and, Shinn notes, the more she said it the more trouble she had. Set against her: the gardener whose cheerful “doesn't it always clear up?” became another woman's answer.

In practice — Stop narrating the problem to others. Replace the complaint with a short release statement.

Don't describe what you don't want.

Giving opens the channel

To receive, give. Giving precedes receiving and opens the channels of supply; clutching closes them. Generosity, not calculation, is the point — “my gifts to others precede God's gifts to me.”

Why it matters — A grasping, closed channel can't receive. Releasing something opens the flow both ways.

In the book — A woman needed five hundred dollars by the first of August. Shinn told her the trouble was she didn't give enough. She began making small gifts and tipping generously; on the first of August her hostess unexpectedly handed her a check for five hundred dollars.

In practice — While you wait, give something — money, time, or goodwill — freely.

Open the channel by giving first.

Follow the hunch: the Divine Design

Shinn holds that each person carries a perfect blueprint — “the perfect picture of the oak is in the acorn.” Intuition is how you read it: “hunches are my hounds of heaven.” Follow the lead and you land in your right place, work, time and pay; force life off-design and you get “unhappy reactions.” And there is no competition on the spiritual plane — what is yours by right cannot be taken by another.

Why it matters — Most people reason their intuitions away. The lead is the shortest route to the life already patterned for you.

In the book — “Magnolia Charlie,” a small-town shoemaker, felt the call of a wider life — leaving work each day to meet the four-fifteen train — but never acted on it. By contrast, a woman who trusted the price that “flashed” into her mind got an eight-hundred-dollar Chinese cabinet for exactly the two hundred she intuitively offered.

In practice — When a small, persistent hunch comes, act on it promptly instead of talking yourself out of it.

Never argue with a hunch.



THE WORD OVER EVERY CONDITION

Applying the method across money, loss, love, the body and the elements, and gathering it into a single repeatable move.

There is no lack, loss, or debt — only belief

“Man comes into the world financed by God,” Shinn writes; everything needed is already on the path, released by faith and the word. What looks like lack, loss, or debt is, in her framework, a false belief lodged in the subconscious — erase it and the thing, or its equivalent, appears.

Why it matters — It reframes shortage as a changeable mental state rather than a fixed fact, which is what makes the word worth speaking at all.

In the book — A woman lost a silver pencil and denied the loss — “there is no loss in divine mind... I will receive it or its equivalent.” Weeks later a friend spontaneously gave her a gold pencil that had cost fifty dollars. Separately, a thousand-dollar debt she'd been unable to collect was repaid within a month after she stopped working on the man and sent him “love and forgiveness.”

In practice — Deny the belief of lack and speak supply; where money is owed, release the debtor with goodwill.

You can only lose what isn't truly yours.

Oneness dissolves the rival

In love and marriage, Shinn traces fear to a belief in duality — the imagined “other woman” a person keeps in the back of her mind. So long as you picture interference, you summon it; in reality, she says, there is only oneness. A marriage lasts when two people live in the same “thought world.”

Why it matters — Jealousy is a vivid negative picture; it works exactly like any other word, and it attracts what it fears.

In the book — A successful man and his wife drifted apart because their thought worlds diverged: he shopped, in effect, on Fifth Avenue while her world stayed on Third Avenue. They inevitably separated — not over money, but over the gap between where each one lived in thought.

In practice — Refuse to rehearse a rival or an interference; grow toward the people you love in shared thought, not apart.

What God has joined, no thought can part.

Health follows harmony

In Shinn's system, sickness comes from “sin” in the old sense — violation of spiritual law — and resentment, fear and hate are said to “tear down the cells” while forgiveness and goodwill restore health. Presented here faithfully as her 1941 New Thought teaching, not as medical guidance: the reliable, defensible core is that a held grudge is a genuine burden on the person carrying it.

Why it matters — It makes your emotional state a matter of consequence, and it puts forgiveness in the category of self-interest, not just virtue.

In the book — Shinn describes a woman whose resentment after a loss (she believed) hardened into illness, and who recovered her health when she became forgiving and harmonious. Treat the physical claim as her account; treat the emotional lesson as sound.

In practice — Release the resentment first — for your own sake — then speak harmony and health. For anything physical, see a doctor.

A grudge costs the one who holds it.

Wave it over the situation

The whole book collapses into one repeatable move, stated in the conclusion: choose the affirmation that appeals to you most and “wave it over the situation which confronts you.” Hold the picture until it “gels,” and don’t talk about a demonstration until it has come to pass.

Why it matters — A method you can’t perform is useless. This turns the entire system into a single habit you can do in any moment.

In the book — A woman sold her house and furniture in the dead of a blizzard — roads nearly impassable — by ignoring the storm, polishing the furniture, and trusting the word. “Faith never looks out of the window at the blizzard.”

In practice — Pick one affirmation, speak it over whatever you’re facing, prepare as though it’s coming, and keep it to yourself until it lands.

Pick one word and wave it.



A FEW DISTINCTIONS

Active faith vs. wishing. Faith here is preparation — digging the ditch, buying the lamp — not hoping with folded hands.

Non-resistance vs. passivity. Blessing an obstacle is an inner move that drains its charge; you still act, you just stop feeding the fight.

A hope chest vs. a faith chest. Both prepare for the good expected; the faith chest is kept private, protected from the doubt of others until it lands.

Intuition vs. impulse. A hunch is calm and persistent and keeps pointing one way; an anxious impulse is spiky and fear-driven.

The Action Guide

Eight moves that turn the method into practice. For each: what to do, when to use it, the problem it addresses, what success looks like, and one caution.

Reword it until it flashes a picture

Do — Before you speak any affirmation or set any intention, rephrase it in concrete, sensory language you can actually see in your mind.

When — Any time you ask for something or set a goal.

Fixes — Vague, abstract requests that don't move you — “more money,” “a better job.”

Working when — Saying it produces a clear mental image and a small lift of feeling.

Caution — Don't strain to force the picture. If it won't come, change the words, not the effort.

Settle your state before you speak

Do — Get calm first — let the fear, anger or urgency drop — then say the word from steadiness.

When — Whenever you notice you're demanding from anxiety or desperation.

Fixes — A word spoken from fear is cancelled by the fear.

Working when — You can state the outcome and feel steady, not frantic.

Caution — Don't perform a fake calm; actually let the charge come down first.

Take one ditch-digging step

Do — Do one concrete thing that only makes sense if the answer is already on its way — clear the space, buy the lamp, prepare the room.

When — After you've asked and nothing is visible yet.

Fixes — Passive waiting that never impresses certainty on the subconscious.

Working when — You've physically acted as if the thing is coming.

Caution — The step should be a genuine preparation, not a reckless gamble.

Bless the obstacle instead of fighting it

Do — When something blocks you, send it goodwill and call it a stepping-stone rather than an enemy.

When — The moment resistance, jealousy or resentment rises.

Fixes — What you resist enlarges; the fight feeds it.

Working when — The emotional charge drops and the obstacle loses its grip.

Caution — Non-resistance is inner, not passivity — you still act, just without the war.

Stop narrating the problem

Do — Quit repeating your troubles to others; replace the complaint with a short release statement, such as “I cast this burden and go free.”

When — Whenever you catch yourself rehearsing what's wrong.

Fixes — Describing the problem out loud multiplies it.

Working when — You feel the pull to complain and redirect it.

Caution — This isn't denying real difficulty — it's refusing to feed it with speech.

Give first to open the channel

Do — Give something — money, time, goodwill — before the thing you want arrives.

When — When supply feels stuck, or you notice you're clutching.

Fixes — A closed, grasping channel can't receive.

Working when — You give freely and notice the flow loosening.

Caution — Give from generosity, not as a transaction meant to force a payout.

Act on the hunch

Do — When a small, persistent intuition arrives, follow it promptly instead of reasoning it away.

When — At the flash of a lead — a nudge to call, go, or do.

Fixes — Over-reasoning that kills the lead before you move.

Working when — You act while the hunch is still fresh.

Caution — Tell a steady intuitive lead (calm, persistent) apart from an anxious impulse (spiky, fearful).

Keep the demonstration private until it lands

Do — Don't talk about what you're expecting until it has actually come to pass.

When — While a hope is still young and forming.

Fixes — Exposing it to other people's doubt — friends “sitting on the hope chest.”

Working when — You hold it quietly and let it gel.

Caution — This is privacy, not secrecy-as-shame — you're protecting a young intention.



THE AFFIRMATIONS

A working set, drawn from the book and grouped by need. Say the one that flashes a picture; hold it until it feels settled.

SUPPLY & PROSPERITY

- *I am linked with an endless golden stream of prosperity, which comes to me under grace in perfect ways.*
- *My supply is endless, inexhaustible, and immediate.*
- *I am fearless in letting money go out, knowing God is my immediate and endless supply.*

SUCCESS & RIGHT WORK

- *Behold, I have set before thee the open door of destiny, and no man shall shut it, for it is nailed back.*
- *I make friends with hindrances, and every obstacle becomes a stepping-stone.*
- *I have a magical work in a magical way; I give magical service for magical pay.*

FAITH & POISE

- *I am unmoved by appearances; therefore appearances move.*
- *My faith is built upon a rock.*
- *I now dig my ditches deep with faith and understanding.*

FEAR & PROTECTION

- *There is nothing to fear, for there is no power to hurt.*
- *I walk up to the lion on my pathway and find an angel in armor.*
- *I am surrounded by the white light of the Christ, through which nothing negative can penetrate.*

LOSS & DEBT

- *There is no loss in divine mind; therefore I cannot lose anything rightfully mine — it will be restored, or I receive its equivalent.*
- *There is no debt in divine mind; all is squared; I send forth love and forgiveness.*

GUIDANCE & INTUITION

- *Hunches are my hounds of heaven; they lead me in the perfect way.*
- *I know just what to do, and give instant obedience to my intuitive leads.*

PEACE & RELEASE

- *I am harmonious, happy, radiant, detached from the tyranny of fear.*
- *I cast every burden on the Christ within, and I go free.*

Quick Reference

The Method

Speak the outcome over the situation — in words vivid enough to picture, from a state calm enough to hold — then prepare as though it's already coming, and keep it to yourself until it lands.

THE PRINCIPLES

- Speak the outcome, not the problem.
- If you can't picture it, reword it.
- Fear demagnetizes; poise magnetizes.
- Prepare for it before you can see it.
- Make friends with the hindrance.
- Don't describe what you don't want.
- Open the channel by giving first.
- Never argue with a hunch.
- A grudge costs the one who holds it.
- Pick one word and wave it.

WHEN YOU FACE... WAVE THIS

Lack

I am linked with an endless golden stream of prosperity.

Fear

I walk up to the lion and find an angel in armor.

An obstacle

Every obstacle becomes a stepping-stone.

Loss

There is no loss in divine mind — it is restored, or its equivalent comes.

A grudge

All is squared; I send forth love and forgiveness.

Waiting

I now dig my ditches deep with faith and understanding.

Overwhelm

I cast every burden and I go free.

A decision

Hunches are my hounds of heaven; they lead me in the perfect way.



“Nothing is too good to be true; nothing is too wonderful to happen; nothing is too good to last.”